

How to identify the major components inside my computer.

Video Transcript : <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yRmPTbGBqVI>

The major _____ and what they do.

Step 1.

The _____/the _____ (central Processing Unit)/ _____ (Random Access Memory)/ _____ /Power supply/ _____ or hard drive/Optical drive (CD or DVD drive)

Step 2. Hardware and Software.

All of these _____ are usually found WITHIN the tower and are referred to as hardware. Hardware can be thought of as the actual parts that go into the computer.

Software refers to the programs and systems that operate within the hardware.

Step 3. Motherboard.

The heart of the computer, the logic board and function board of a PC. Every other component is attached to it in some way. All of the different components use the motherboard to communicate and connect with each other. It has a series of expansion slots and connectors attached to the back of the PC. The graphics card and sound card are INSTALLED directly onto the MOBO. The RAM and hard drive communicate with the motherboard through various connections. There are a WIDE RANGE of motherboards to choose from, with different features, prices, and the operating systems supported. With also different form factors called the AT, ATX, and Mini-ITX.

Step 4. The CPU. Central Processing Unit.

The brain of the computer. It is often referred to as the processor or the microprocessor. It is found under a heat sink and fan and is directly under the motherboard. The CPU directs, controls, and coordinates all of the communication between the other components and manages all of the data. It is not really thinking but managing all calculations. It is the software that people write that translate these calculations into useful information for us.

Step 5. RAM. Random Access Memory.

Comes as modules in predefined amounts. It's usually f_____ d_____ y on the m_____ and usually in _____ or _____ slots. The memory chips store information temporarily for _____ use by the _____. The _____ is used to s_____ i_____ n for _____ that are directly being used by the CPU at any given time. The _____'s RAM _____ is an _____ different _____ from the H_____ D_____. The _____ s_____ information permanently (for _____ use).

Step 6. Graphics card.

Or _____ translates information into the g_____ s and text that appear on the _____. Most _____ include a _____ specifically designed for the _____ a _____ called an AGP slot (Advanced Graphics Port). Modern graphics adaptors usually incorporate some _____ right on the card to _____ their _____.

Step 7. Power supply.

This _____ to the other _____, which is why it has so many _____ coming out of it. It is usually positioned at the back _____ corner of the computer case. The power supply has a _____ into it to keep itself and the _____.

Step 8. The hard disk

A hard disk, which is also called a _____ is much like a _____ cabinet. The _____ and _____ are s_____ on the hard disk, and the computer _____ them as they are needed. When the computer _____ the hard drive, it is _____ ing and m_____ the _____ information into the RAM memory. That _____ is the temporary _____. However, the original _____ is still on the _____ and is left undisturbed until the file is saved. When the computer _____ or _____ information, it _____ the data to the hard disk. That process results in the _____ being _____ or modified with the new information. If you _____ to a new file or _____ new software, the information is _____ to the disk and then available on a used _____ of the disk.

Step 9. The optical drive

The optical drive is often called a _____ or a _____. It sits at the _____ of the _____ for ease of access, and uses a _____ to _____ and _____ in _____ to CDs and DVDs.

Done!